



FUTURE SHOOTERS

Developing the big picture

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The big trend since the 2010s were mirrorless cameras, and the proliferation of lens mounts. If things keep going as they are, we may see such an abomination as a full frame mirrorless. DSLRs are considered to be dying, but we like to wait and watch. The other big progress was the ISO numbers shooting up, with the Nikon D6 going all the way up to 3.2million. Pretty soon all cameras will be able to shoot in pitch darkness. People say that smartphones have killed the point and shoot, but there are still some premium compacts such as the Sony RX100 that are pocketable, and offer capabilities unmatched by smartphones. The value proposition of these cameras mostly rest in the 10x-30x optical zoom, offered in models by Nikon, Panasonic and Sony. The high-end compacts can always go the rugged way, throw in GPS and appeal to the adventurer, which is the approach taken by the Olympus TG-5. This is a market where there is a potential for a lot of innovation so we expect trade shows (or Kickstarters) in the future to be populated by a model that sanitises itself, or is kid friendly, or throws in thermal imaging, or rounds up the batch that failed testing and package it for hipsters. Gimmicks like

that are needed to rescue the point and shoot from oblivion. While we have seen the odd wearable cameras shown off in trade shows, that is a category with a lot of potential that has not taken off yet. The real innovation when it comes to camera tech, is going on in home security cameras that seem to be doing it all. They are getting infused with AI, are going wireless and storing data in the cloud, and these are the things that are expected to spread out to other categories as well.

AHEAD IN THE CLOUD

It's not surprising that the cloud storage offerings with cameras are somewhat limited, as even smartphone-cloud integration is not what it could be at the moment. There

was the NextBit Robin, an oddball of a phone that primarily used cloud storage, and the unlimited photo storage available with Google Pixel, but these are the exceptions rather than the norm. While some cameras do bundle in cloud storage subscriptions with the hardware, there is nothing holistic that is so easy to use that you shoot once, forget about it, and then access from anywhere. One category of cameras that do use cloud storage to the fullest extent however, are home security cameras. The Nest cameras with integrated Google Assistant are sold as a subscription service that has the cloud storage included. The Ring cameras with Alexa throws in cloud storage as an upsell. The Arlo cameras are also sold as a subscrip-



D-Link security cameras